

Phishing Email Analysis and IOC Extraction Report

Project: Phishing Email Analysis and IOC Extraction Workflow

Case Study: Download Document Here

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Classification: Phishing Email

1. Executive Summary

This report analyzes a phishing email that impersonates a secure document-sharing service (Citrix Files) to deceive recipients into downloading a fake document. The attacker uses urgency, brand impersonation, link redirection, and credential harvesting techniques to trick users into entering their login credentials on a fraudulent website.

2. Scenario Overview

The email claims that the recipient has received an important fax document that must be downloaded before the link expires. The "Download Document Here" button redirects users to a fake login page where attackers attempt to steal usernames and passwords.

3. Phishing Techniques Identified

Artificial Urgency

- The email states that the download link expires on the same day.
- This pressures recipients into acting quickly without verifying the email.

Brand Impersonation

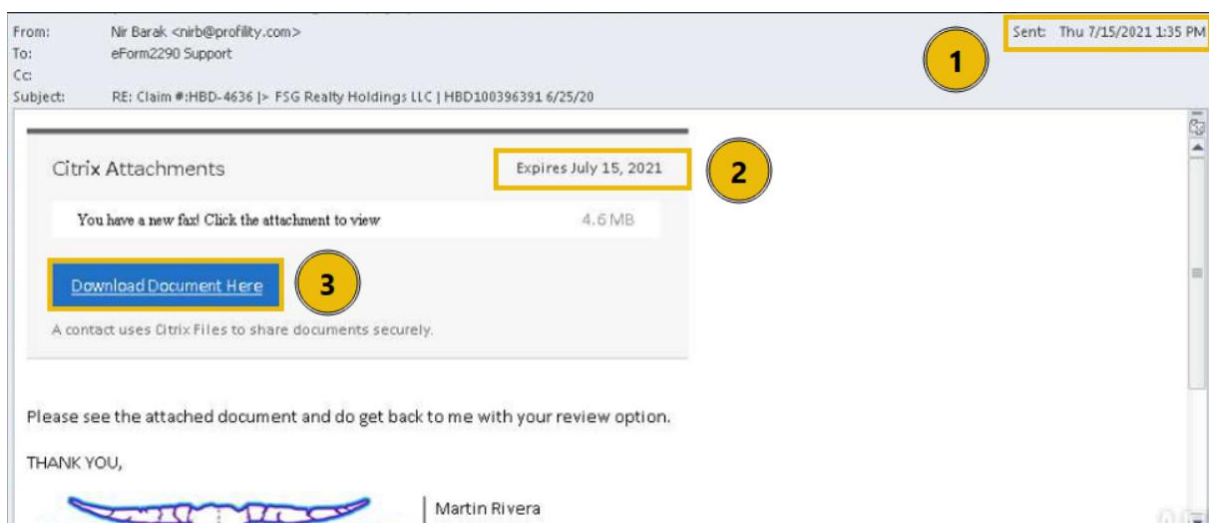
- The attacker imitates Citrix Files, Microsoft, and Adobe branding.
- Legitimate logos and formatting increase the credibility of the email.

Link Redirection

- The download button redirects users through multiple URLs.
- This technique hides the final malicious destination from users and some email filters.

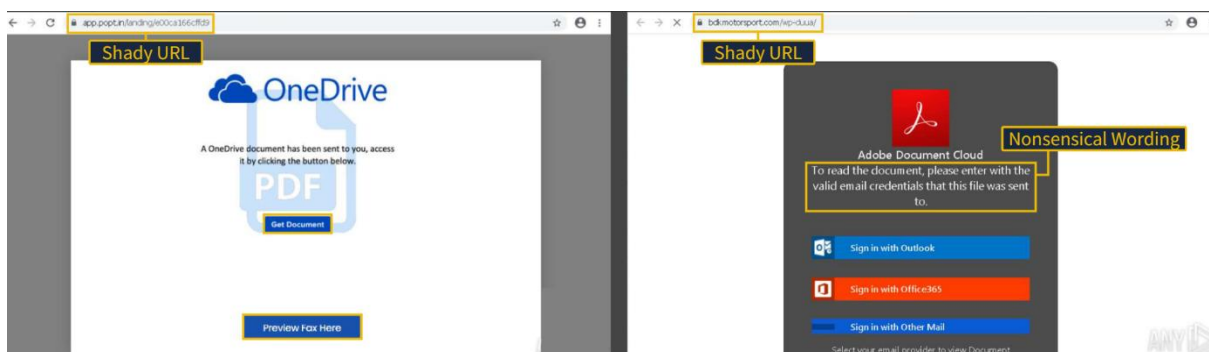
Credential Harvesting

- The fake download page requests user credentials.
- Submitted usernames and passwords are sent directly to the attacker.



4. Indicators of Compromise (IOCs)

IOC Type	Value
Brand Used	Citrix Files
Email Theme	Fax Document
Attack Category	Phishing
Delivery Method	Malicious Hyperlink
Action Requested	Download Document
Social Engineering	Urgency



5. Analysis Findings

Subject Analysis

The subject references an important fax document, encouraging the recipient to review it immediately.

Sender Analysis

The email attempts to appear as a legitimate business communication. The sender should always be verified before interacting with the message.

Content Analysis

The message creates urgency by mentioning that the document download expires on the same day. Trusted branding is used to make the email appear authentic.

Hyperlink Analysis

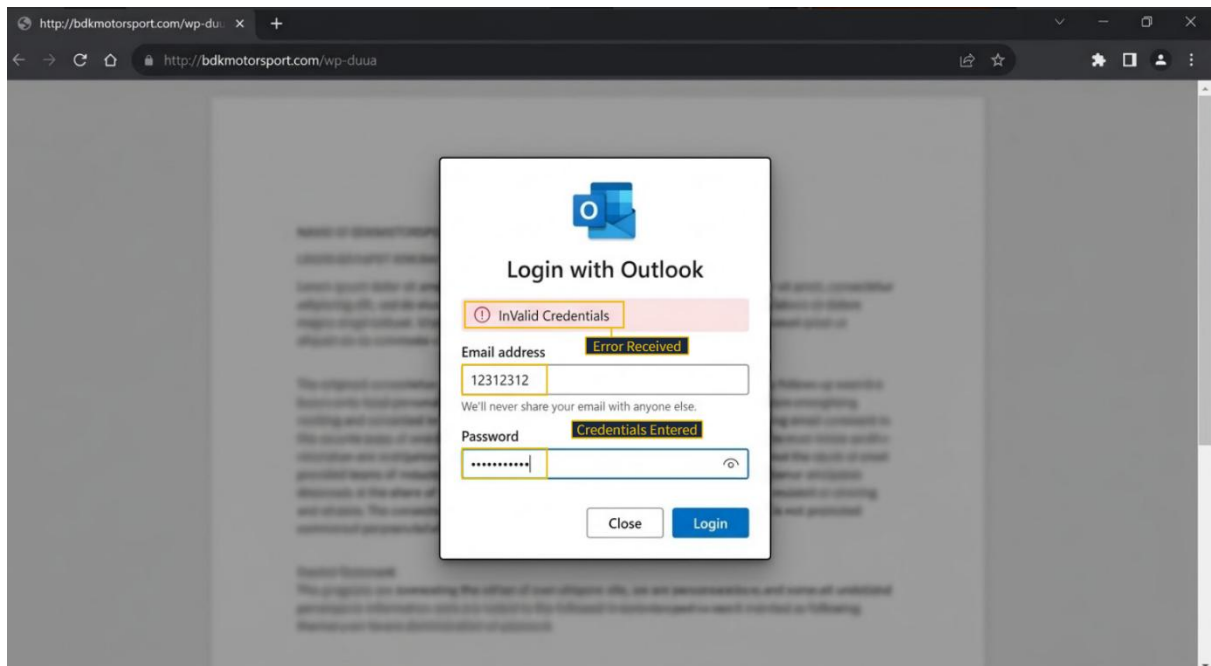
The "**Download Document Here**" button is the primary attack vector. Clicking it may redirect users to:

- Fake Microsoft login pages
- Fake Adobe login pages
- Credential harvesting websites
- Malware delivery pages

Credential Harvesting Analysis

If the victim enters login credentials, the attacker may:

- Steal corporate accounts
- Gain unauthorized access to business systems
- Conduct further phishing attacks using compromised accounts



6. Detection Opportunities

- Inspect embedded URLs.
- Detect URL redirection or shortened links.
- Block known phishing domains.

7. Risk Assessment

Risk Level: High

Severity: High

Confidence: High

Category: Phishing / Credential Harvesting

Reasons

- Artificial urgency
- Trusted brand impersonation
- Hidden malicious hyperlinks
- Credential theft
- Potential account compromise

8. MITRE ATT&CK Mapping

Technique ID : T1566.002

Technique Name : Phishing: Spearphishing Link

The attacker delivers a phishing email containing a malicious hyperlink that redirects the victim to a fraudulent website for credential theft, malware delivery, or other malicious activity.

9. Recommended Actions

1. Do not click the download button.
2. Verify document-sharing requests directly with the sender.
3. Hover over hyperlinks before clicking to inspect the destination.
4. Block the sender's email address and associated domains.
5. Report the email to the security team.
6. Enable Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) on business accounts.
7. Educate users about document-sharing phishing attacks.

10. Conclusion

This email is a phishing attempt that impersonates a trusted document-sharing service to steal user credentials. Multiple phishing indicators—including artificial urgency, brand impersonation, link redirection, and credential harvesting—confirm that the email should be classified as malicious and blocked.